NTNU MUSEUM, TAIPEI

Persona 01

Robot-averse visitor • prefers to explore the museum on her own



Lin Mei-Hua

FICTIONAL RESEARCH PERSONA

"I came here to look at the paintings, not to be looked after. If I need help, I will ask a person."

SNAPSHOT

OCCUPATION
Senior editor, cultural magazine

AGE
44 years

CITY OF RESIDENCE
Taipei, Taiwan

FAMILY STATUS
Married, one teenage child

EDUCATION LEVEL
Master's degree (art history)

LANGUAGES
Mandarin, Hokkien, good English

VISITS
6–8 a year, alone, Saturday afternoons

PROFILE SCORES

Comfort with robots	■□□□□
Comfort with smartphones	■■■■□
Wish for company	■□□□□
Art knowledge	■■■■■
Privacy concern	■■■■■

Design assumptions, not survey data.

WHO SHE IS

Mei-Hua edits a cultural magazine, so her week is made of deadlines, screens and other people's opinions. The museum is the one place where she decides what to look at, for how long, and what to think about it. She is not afraid of technology; she uses her phone all day. What she rejects is **being accompanied, followed or addressed by a machine** in a space she treats as a place for quiet thinking.

THE CORE INSIGHT

She does not reject help. She rejects *unrequested* help. The robot is acceptable only when she is the one who starts it.

VISIT MOTIVATION & GOALS

WHY SHE COMES

- Quiet time with art at her **own pace**
- An escape from the deadlines of her work week
- Forms her own view before reading any wall text

WHAT SHE NEEDS

- Uninterrupted time with each artwork
- A fact or an artist's name quickly, *when she asks*
- To feel like a visitor, not a user being managed

INTERACTION PROFILE & PAIN POINTS

HOW SHE INTERACTS

- Robot comfort **very low**, smartphone comfort high
- Accepts help **only when she starts it**: button, QR code or phone
- Asks staff or reads the leaflet when she is stuck

WHAT BOTHERS HER

- A robot that approaches, follows or speaks in the gallery
- Greetings, tour offers and feedback requests
- Cameras that seem to log where she looks, and a "no, thank you" that is ignored

BELIEFS ABOUT ROBOTS

INTRUSIVE
"A robot near me changes how I look at art."

PERSONAL
"Understanding a painting is mine to do. A script cannot do it for me."

WATCHED
"Where I linger says a lot about me. Who sees that data?"

SHE ACCEPTS THE ROBOT IF…

She calls it with a deliberate action. It stays **silent** and keeps 2 m or more of distance. It never blocks her view of an artwork. She can see that **no data** is kept about her. Robots that only clean, carry or monitor safety are fine with her.

DESIGN RULES FOR OUR MUSEUM GUIDE ROBOT

- **Opt-in only:** never approaches first
- **Clear "no":** a badge or app switch that is always respected
- **Read refusal cues:** a turned back or a step away means "no"
- **Silent by default:** no voice or sound in the galleries
- **Privacy first:** no face or gaze recording when opted out
- **Human fallback:** staff and leaflets stay an equal option